



A colored engraving depicts the massacre of Sioux Indians at Wounded Knee Creek, South Dakota, by US soldiers of the 7th Cavalry Regiment.

IN THE US, TENSIONS AND SPORADIC FIGHTING in the west between US troops and American Indians had continued since the **Battle at Little Bighorn** (see 1876). In addition to this, American Indians faced increasingly harsh living conditions: poverty, disease, and crop failures were rife. By the 1880s, a new mysticism called the **Ghost Dance** had emerged among the **Sioux** people, based on the belief that an Indian messiah would come in 1891 and unite all the displaced native peoples. This newfound belief manifested in trances, dances, and a mass frenzy, which worried the US agents who oversaw the reservations. They attempted to stop the dances, and the Sioux people rebelled, with US army troops being called in by the end of the year.

The reservation of Wounded Knee Creek in South Dakota was the scene of a massacre on December 29, when around 150 American Indians—men, women, and children—were killed and 50 were wounded by US troops. During disarmament of the Sioux tribe a scuffle had broken out, and in the ensuing carnage around 25



6:1 **Wounded Knee dead**
The massacre left 150 Sioux dead, while 25 troops from the US army were killed. A further 50 Sioux were wounded during the conflict.

US soldiers were also left dead, many due to friendly fire from US machine guns. This was the last major conflict between American Indians and the US Army, although poor relations persisted between the two groups.

In Europe, a small island off the North Sea coast of Germany, near the territory of Schleswig-Holstein, **Heligoland**, had formally come into British possession in 1814, having been seized by the Royal Navy seven years earlier. However, as Germany's European and African expansion continued, a deal was struck for Britain to hand over the island to Germany in exchange for the islands of **Zanzibar** and **Pemba**, near Tanzania's port of Tanga off the East African coast. Germany developed Heligoland into a large naval base.

Zanzibar was added to Britain's substantial territory in Africa, building on earlier deals struck with Germany, as well as claims made following the Berlin Conference (see 1885). In the following year, Britain formally established the **Nyasaland Districts**

Protectorate. This became known as the "British Central Africa Protectorate" in 1893 and was then officially designated as "Nyasaland" in 1907. Part of this territory lay along Lake Nyasa and the Shire valley in present-day Malawi).

Sioux weapon

A 19th-century style knife and beaded rawhide sheath, as carried by American Indian Sioux warriors.



The Trans-Siberian Railway during its construction in Russia.

5,785 MILES
THE DISTANCE BETWEEN MOSCOW AND VLADIVOSTOK ON THE TRANS-SIBERIAN RAILWAY

IN RUSSIA, CONSTRUCTION HAD BEGUN ON AN EXTENSIVE RAILROAD SYSTEM across its vast territory. The project was the idea of Alexander III (1845–94), and it was known as the **Trans-Siberian Railway**. It stretched from Moscow to the port of **Vladivostok**, 5,715 miles (9,198 km) to the east. Russia received permission from China to run tracks through parts of Manchuria, allowing the completion of a trans-Manchurian line by 1901. The work began from west and east ends and eventually met in the center. By 1904, the sections linking Moscow and Vladivostok were connected and running. The railroad facilitated the quicker movement of people through Russia and allowed for the further settlement of sparsely populated **Siberia**.



The Great Mosque of Djenne, Mali, was built after the French took control.



French in Africa

A postage stamp from French West Africa shows an illustration of a native mask. France managed to gain control of much of the region.

BRITAIN AND FRANCE WERE CONTINUING THEIR PUSH into West Africa. The British had secured ports along the coast, annexing Lagos in 1861. Lagos provided a key point from which to seize control of surrounding **Yorubaland**, situated around the lower parts of the Niger River, corresponding with much of modern southwest Nigeria. The British took advantage of existing internal divisions among Yoruba rulers, and in 1892, they overthrew the **Ijebu** government, part of the Yoruba political system.

Likewise, the French exploited divisions in the Muslim **Tukulor Empire** by signing treaties with its neighbors and building forts within Tukulor territory. By 1892, the French controlled much of the region around the Senegal River.

January 15 Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky's *Sleeping Beauty* performed at St. Petersburg, Russia

July 1 Heligoland-Zanzibar treaty between Britain and Germany

November 23 William III of Netherlands dies; Luxembourg breaks away over succession to throne

March Construction of the Trans-Siberian Railway begins (finishes 1917)

Malawi becomes a British protectorate

January 7 Abbas II becomes khedive of Egypt (to 1914)

May 19 British defeat Ijebu (present-day Nigeria) with Maxim gun at River Yemaja

June 28 Cecil Rhodes' British South Africa Company begins colonization of Southern African territory

July 29 Dutch post-impressionist artist Vincent van Gogh dies two days after shooting himself (b. 1853)

December 29 Massacre at Wounded Knee in which the US Army kills 150 Sioux, including women and children

March 29 George Seurat (1859–91) leading figure in neo-impressionist movement dies

October Paleontologist Eugene Dubois (1858–1940) finds first remains of *Homo erectus*

Dimitri Ivanovsky (1864–1920) discovers viruses